Gagandeep Sachdeva

gsachdeva@povertyactionlab.org
+1 (831)-295-3570
Personal Website

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Fields: Economics of Education, Labor Economics, Development Economics

Current Positions

Postdoctoral Fellow, J-PAL South Asia 2026–
PI: Dr Karthik Muralidharan (UC San Diego) and Dr Abhijeet Singh (Stockholm School of Economics)

Visiting Scholar, 21st Century India Center at UC San Diego 2026–

Education

PhD in Economics, University of California, Santa Cruz 2026
Committee Chair: Dr Laura Giuliano

MPhil in Economics, Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research 2018

MSc in Economics, Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research 2017
Awarded the Chancellor's Gold Medal for the Best-Performing Student in The M.Sc. Program.

BA (Hons) Economics, University of Delhi 2015

Publications

Affirmative Action, Faculty Productivity, and Caste Interactions: Evidence from Engineering Colleges in India with Robert Fairlie, Saurabh Khanna, and Prashant Loyalka [Link to Paper]
Forthcoming, **Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics**

Working Papers

Relative Skills in the Classroom: Teachers' Gender-Differentiated Impacts on Test Scores and Course Grades [Link to Paper]
(Job Market Paper, Under Review)

Female Faculty Reduce Anxiety About STEM and Raise Academic Achievement Among Female Undergraduates with Robert Fairlie, Mridul Joshi, Saurabh Khanna, and Prashant Loyalka
Revise and Resubmit, **Nature Communications**
(Draft Available Upon Request)

Nonlinear Segregation Dynamics in Schooling Markets: The Case of Caste in India with Moumita Das, Shreya Dutt, and Kartik Srivastava [Link to Paper]
(Revisions in Progress)

Works in Progress

Class Size Effects in Developing Countries: Longitudinal Evidence from India with Arushi Kaushik and Karthik Muralidharan *(Draft coming soon)*

Contract Teachers: Experimental Evidence from India with Karthik Muralidharan and Venkatesh Sundararaman

Long-Term Effects of Teacher Performance Pay with Karthik Muralidharan

Friday Night Lights, Monday Morning Grades: How High School Football Success Affects Student Achievement with Evan Bennett, Derek Rury, and Sofia Shchukina

Teaching and Mentoring Experience

Instructor of Record, Department of Economics, UCSC 2024
Intermediate Microeconomics (Online Asynchronous)

Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, UCSC 2020–2026

Graduate: Applied Econometrics I; Applications in Microeconomics

Undergraduate: Intermediate Microeconomics (×5), Introductory Microeconomics (×4), Introductory Macroeconomics (×2), Industrial Organization, Economic Rhetoric

Graduate Pedagogy Fellow, Teaching and Learning Center, UCSC 2022–2026

Peer Mentor, Summer GSI Support Team, Teaching and Learning Center, UCSC 2024

Research and Work Experience

Graduate Student Researcher, UC Santa Cruz 2020–2024

Research Associate, Economic Research Unit, Koan Advisory 2019

Research Assistant, Delhi School of Economics 2017

Grants, Awards, and Fellowships

Dissertation Completion Fellowship, Department of Economics, UCSC 2025

Summer Dissertation Fellowship, Division of Social Sciences, UCSC 2025

Summer GSI Peer Support Fellowship, Teaching and Learning Center, UCSC 2024

Dissertation Research Grant, Department of Economics, UCSC 2022–24

Graduate Pedagogy Fellowship, Teaching and Learning Center, UCSC 2022

Regents' Fellowship, Graduate Division, UCSC 2019

Chancellor's Gold Medal for the Best-Performing Student in The M.Sc. Program, IGIDR 2017

Conferences, Invited Talks, and Summer Schools

Invited Speaker, Center for Education Policy Research, Harvard University 2026

Invited Speaker, Behavioral Insights and Parenting Lab, University of Chicago 2026

Finalist, Grad Slam, UCSC Graduate Division 2026

Invited Speaker, Brown Bag Seminar, Oregon State University 2025

47th Fall Research Conference, APPAM 2025

Invited Speaker, Economics Department Seminar Series, South Asian University, New Delhi 2024

Socio-Economic Mobility and Inequality, Harris School of Public Policy, University of Chicago 2024

Graduate Symposium, UCSC Graduate Division 2024

Southern Economic Association, 93rd Annual Meeting, New Orleans 2023

Biennial Conference on Development, Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research 2022

Theory-Driven Experiments, Center for Theoretical and Experimental Social Sciences, CalTech 2022

All-California Labor Economics Conference, UCSC (poster session) 2019

Technical Skills

Data analysis: Stata, R, Microsoft Excel

Optimization and Computation: Wolfram Mathematica

Agentic AI–assisted research workflows: pipeline development and automation with coding agents (Claude Code), integrated with Stata, Python, and Latex